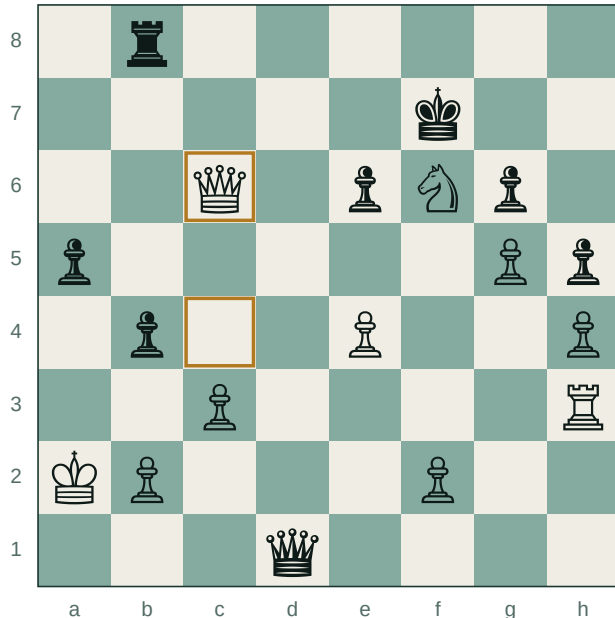


Mate in two: Black, move 31

Mate in two

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Qxc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...b3+ 32. Ka3 Qa1#

31...b3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **32.Ka3**.

32...Qa1# Mate: queen on a1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a3. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on a1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The displayed line is one recorded defense. Test other legal replies instead of assuming the defender must copy it.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A mating combination must survive the defender's reply. The first move should force a position in which a second move ends the game against every defense.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the likely mating square and the defender that prevents it. Calculate the forcing move that removes that resource.

The defending king is on a2. Geometrically undefended: queen on c6 and rook on h3. Check for tactical protection.